

Far and Away

Please answer the following questions in complete sentences, using detailed descriptions, as you watch the movie.



1. Why did Steven Chase burn down Joseph's house?

2. Why did Shannon want to leave Ireland? (a **push factor**)

3. What was a **pull factor** for both Joseph and Shannon that led them to America?

4. Did Shannon and Joseph travel in steerage class?

5. Did Shannon and Joseph have to go through Ellis Island?

Explain why:



Stop at 43:00 and read this section from the textbook that explains what political machines are to help you answer question 6.

The Emergence of Political Machines

In the late 19th century, cities experienced rapid growth under inefficient government. In a climate influenced by dog-eat-dog Social Darwinism, cities were receptive to a new power structure, the political machine, and a new politician, the city boss.

THE POLITICAL MACHINE The **political machine** was an organized group that controlled the activities of a political party in a city. It also offered services to voters and businesses in exchange for political or financial support. In the decades after the Civil War, political machines gained control of local government in Baltimore, New York, San Francisco, and other major cities.

The machine was organized like a pyramid. At the pyramid's base were local precinct workers and captains who reported to a ward boss. They tried to get voters' support on a city block or in a neighborhood. At election time, the ward boss worked to secure the vote in all the precincts in the ward, or electoral district. Ward bosses helped the poor and gained their votes by doing favors or providing services. As Martin Lomasney, elected ward boss of Boston's West End in 1885, explained, "There's got to be in every ward somebody that any bloke can come to . . . and get help. Help, you understand; none of your law and your justice, but help." At the top of the pyramid was the city boss, who controlled the activities of the political party throughout the city. Precinct captains, ward bosses, and the city boss worked together to elect their candidates and guarantee the success of the machine.

THE ROLE OF THE POLITICAL BOSS Whether or not the boss officially served as mayor, he controlled access to municipal jobs and business licenses. He also influenced the courts and other municipal agencies. Bosses like Roscoe Conkling in New York City used their power to build parks, sewer systems, and waterworks. They also gave money to schools, hospitals, and orphanages. Bosses could also provide government support for new businesses, a service for which they were often paid extremely well.

It was not only money that motivated city bosses. By solving urban problems, bosses could reinforce voters' loyalty, gain additional political support, and extend their influence.

IMMIGRANTS AND THE MACHINE Many precinct captains and political bosses were first-generation or second-generation immigrants. Few were educated beyond grammar school. They entered politics early and worked their way up from the bottom. They could speak to immigrants in their own language and understood the challenges that newcomers faced. More important, the bosses were able to provide solutions. The machines—such as New York City's powerful Democratic political

machine Tammany Hall—helped immigrants with naturalization (attaining full citizenship). They also helped immigrants find housing and jobs, the newcomers' most important needs. In return, the immigrants provided the votes that the political bosses needed.

"Big Jim" Pendergast, an Irish American saloonkeeper, worked his way up from precinct captain to Democratic city boss in Kansas City, Missouri. He did this by helping Italian, African, and Irish American voters in his ward. By 1900 he controlled Missouri state politics as well.

"I've been called a boss. All there is to it is having friends, doing things for people, and then later on they'll do things for you. . . . You can't coerce people into doing things for you—you can't make them vote for you. I never coerced anybody in my life. Wherever you see a man bulldozing anybody he don't last long."

—James Pendergast, quoted in *The Pendergast Machine*



6. The Ward Boss, Mike Kelly helped Shannon and Joseph.

- How did he help them?

- Why did he help them?

7. What was the building like that they lived in?

8. What kind of jobs did they get? What were the conditions like?



9. Why were Shannon and Joseph saving money?

10. What did Joseph do that caused them to get thrown out of the boarding house? WHO makes the decision to kick them out?

11. Why do Shannon's parents leave Ireland and come to America?

a. Identify on PUSH factor:

b. Identify one PULL factor: